

Talking About Sex Without Taboo

Daring to voice your wants, limits, and feelings

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice · 18+ — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Daring to voice your wants, limits, and feelings

Many couples make love without ever really talking about it. Yet without communication, you guess, you avoid, you pile up unspoken things — and both pleasure and connection suffer.

This guide helps you understand where the taboo comes from, allow yourself your wants and limits, and talk about it with concrete tools.

Your intention

What you'd like to be able to say (or ask) your partner: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

Where the taboo comes from

Upbringing, modesty, fear of judgment, inherited scripts about 'what's said and not said': silence around sex is learned early.

Understanding the taboo's origin helps you not mistake it for an absolute rule.

Example

Raised where 'it wasn't talked about', Aïcha didn't dare express anything. Linking the block to her history helped her dare.

My relationship to the topic

What messages did you get, as a child/teen, about talking about sex?

What I don't dare say

Write (for yourself) one thing you'd like to say or ask, but don't dare.

→ *The taboo was learned — it isn't an absolute rule.*

The thoughts that block speaking

'If I ask that, they'll judge me', 'it should be natural/obvious', 'I'll upset them': these thoughts close the conversation before it starts.

Softening them makes speaking possible.

Example

Sure his partner would 'take it badly', Tom stayed silent. A gentle, positive phrasing opened a calm exchange.

Blockers journal

Note: the thought that blocks you · a fairer version.

Reframe

Turn 'it should be obvious' into 'no one reads minds — talking about it is normal'.

→ *No one reads minds — talking is healthy, not awkward.*

The right to your wants & limits

Your desires are legitimate, and so is your 'no'. Talking isn't demanding: it's sharing, to meet each other better. Listening to the other with the same openness completes the dialogue.

You have the right to want, and the right not to want.

Example

By expressing a wish without turning it into a demand, Léa found her partner was curious, not reluctant.

My wants & limits

Write: a want you'd like to share · a limit you want to set.

Listening to the other

How to invite your partner to share theirs, without judgment?

→ *I have the right to my wants — and to my limits.*

Tools for talking about it

Concretely: choose the right moment (out of bed, without reproach), speak in 'I', start with the positive, see consent as an ongoing dialogue, and listen as much as you speak.

Communication transforms intimacy — gradually, one topic at a time.

Example

By starting with 'what I love with you is...' before raising a wish, Sofia opened a relaxed, close dialogue.

My opening

Prepare an 'I' opening line that starts with the positive.

The right setting

What moment/setting, out of bed and without reproach, for this conversation?

→ *The right moment, the 'I', the positive first — and listening.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Choose a calm moment, out of bed and without reproach.
- Speak in 'I' ('I'd like', 'I feel') rather than judgment.
- Start with what you enjoy, before what's missing.
- Asking isn't demanding — and a 'no' is always respected.
- Consent is an ongoing dialogue, not a box ticked once.
- Listen as much as you speak, and move gradually (one topic at a time).

To fill in

My wants & limits

A want to share	A limit to set

My conversation

My opening (in 'I')	The right moment/setting

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Understand where my taboo comes from.

Week 2 — Soften the thoughts that block speaking.

Week 3 — Allow myself my wants & limits.

Week 4 — Talk about it with the right tools.

Your plan in 3 lines

- The want I want to share:
- The limit I want to set:
- My 'I' opening line:

TO CLOSE

Daring to talk — that's where pleasure and connection grow.

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Adults only (18+). This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool for intimate wellbeing — not therapy, nor medical or sex-therapy advice. In case of pain, persistent difficulty or distress, consult a sex therapist or doctor. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.